



SEPTEMBER 14-20, 2026

8

SONG 41 Please Hear My Prayer

Find Comfort in the Book of Isaiah

“This is what Jehovah says: . . . ‘As a mother comforts her son, so I will keep comforting you.’”—ISA. 66:12, 13.

FOCUS

How meditating on the book of Isaiah can lift our spirits when we

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² In the Bible, Jehovah compares himself to a caring and loving mother who comforts her child. He says: “As a mother comforts her son, so I will keep comforting you.” ([Isa. 66:13](#)) Jehovah’s love for us is greater than that of any parent. ([Isa. 49:15](#)) Through His Word, the Bible, Jehovah provides us with the comfort and strength we need when we are downhearted or are in distress.—[Rom. 15:4](#).

3. What will we consider in this article?

³ The book of Isaiah is filled with comforting expressions from Jehovah. ([Isa. 40:1](#)) Our loving Father inspired the writing of the book to assure his people during a turbulent period in Judah’s history. We too live in “critical times hard to deal with” and therefore need comfort. ([2 Tim. 3:1](#)) Let us consider some verses in the book of Isaiah that can soothe and fortify us when we are (1) faced with an unexpected change in circumstances, (2) plagued with excessive

9

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serving for about 17 years at Bethel, says: “I felt lost. It was a huge challenge to start a new life after being at Bethel for so long. I didn’t know where to start.” What assurance does Jehovah provide through Isaiah if we have to deal with an unexpected change in circumstances?

5. As found at [Isaiah 42:16](#), what assurance does Jehovah provide for us? (See also picture.)

5 Read [Isaiah 42:16](#). Jehovah promises to lead those who are figuratively blind along unfamiliar paths and to turn darkness into light. The expressions “blind,” “unfamiliar paths,” “darkness,” and “rugged terrain” may well describe the way we view our future when our circumstances change unexpectedly. We might feel as if we were walking through a dense forest, unsure of the path ahead. Yet, Jehovah assures us that whatever situation we face, he will give us the guidance we need and will never abandon us. He will take us by the

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*"On unfamiliar paths . . . ,
I will not abandon [you]"*

Even when your circumstances change unexpectedly, Jehovah will never abandon you (See paragraph 5) #

6. If our circumstances change unexpectedly, of what can we be sure?

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WHEN PLAGUED WITH EXCESSIVE GUILT

7. What struggle may some have because of their past mistakes?

⁷ When we confess a serious sin that we have committed, we receive loving help from the elders and we thereafter work hard not to repeat the sin. ([Prov. 28:13](#); [Jas. 5:14-16](#); [1 John 1:9](#)) However, even after we have been shown mercy, we may still struggle with persistent guilt. We might think, ‘How could Jehovah ever forgive me for what I have done?’ ([2 Cor. 2:7](#)) This feeling is understandable because the weight of past mistakes can be heavy and the memory of them can linger. “There is no peace within my bones because of my sin,” King David wrote. “I have grown numb and become completely crushed.” ([Ps. 38:3, 8](#)) If you feel this way at times because of past mistakes, the book of Isaiah offers comfort.

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defined David, not by his mistakes, but by his faithful course. Similarly, Jehovah lovingly forgives us when we repent, and he helps us move forward with a clean conscience. What other assurance can we find in the book of Isaiah when plagued by excessive guilt?

10. What comforting assurance do we find at [Isaiah 38:17](#)?

10 Read [Isaiah 38:17](#) and footnote. The phrase “you have thrown all ¹¹ my sins behind your back” could also be rendered “you have removed all my sins from your sight.” Jehovah is here depicted as taking the sins of a repentant wrongdoer and throwing them behind Him, where He no longer sees them or thinks about them. According to one reference work, the idea may be expressed: “You have made [my sins] as if they had not happened.” So when Jehovah forgives our sins, to him, it is as though we had never sinned. Once Jehovah forgives us, he will never bring up our past sins to accuse or punish us again. He

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complete. He is not ashamed of us because of our past mistakes, and he is not like imperfect people who hold a grudge. ([Isa. 57:16](#)) What really matters to Jehovah is, not the person we were, but the person we are today and the person we are striving to become. ([Isa. 55:7](#)) What a loving and forgiving God we serve! Therefore, may we never allow our past mistakes to ruin our present happiness or to deprive us of future blessings. 12



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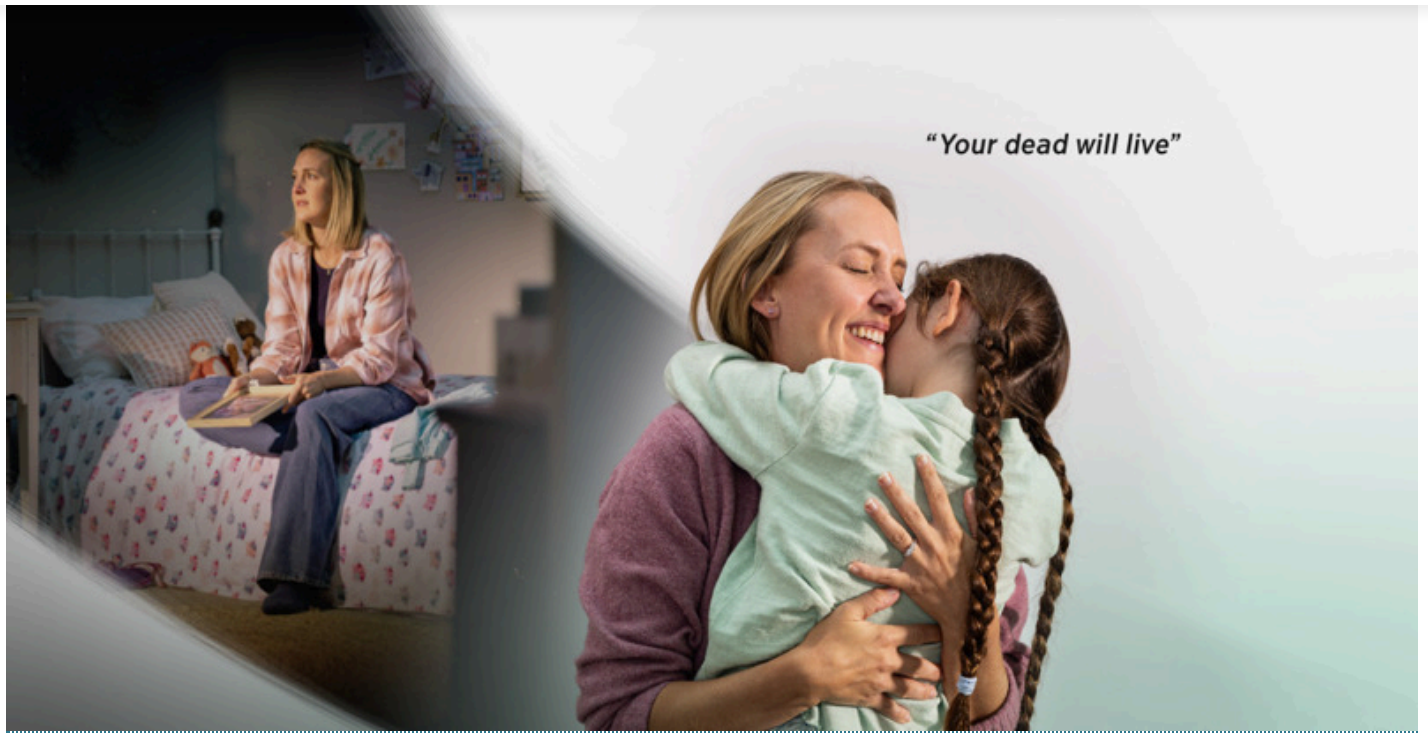
his parents in a fire. He says: “My heart broke to pieces, and I was angry at Jehovah for allowing them to die. I know that he didn’t cause their death, but he didn’t stop it either.” Perhaps you have felt similarly. In such moments of sorrow, what comfort and hope does Jehovah provide?

13. What promise does Jehovah hold out to us at [Isaiah 25:8](#)?

13 Read [Isaiah 25:8](#). Jehovah promises to “swallow up death forever.” Imagine the time when death is no more! You will never again have to mourn the loss of someone you loved. ([Isa. 35:10](#)) You will never again experience the heartache of looking at a marker that tells you where your loved one is buried. Instead, you have the prospect of always having your loved ones with you, alive and in good health. This promise is not based on wishful thinking but is given by the only one capable of fulfilling it—God himself.—[Rev. 21:4, 5](#).

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The hope of seeing our loved ones return to life is guaranteed (See paragraph 14)

15. How does the promise of the resurrection help us cope with grief?

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16 We have considered a few verses from the book of Isaiah that can comfort us when we face an unexpected change in our circumstances, when we are plagued by excessive guilt, and when we are grieving. How grateful we are that Jehovah comforts and soothes us by means of his Word! ([Ps. 94:19](#)) Is there a scripture that you find particularly comforting when facing a distressing situation? Memorize it if you can, write it out in a journal, or post it where you will see it often. And may you find comfort from the soothing words of our loving heavenly Father, Jehovah.

WHAT COMFORTING THOUGHTS DO YOU FIND AT . . .

- [Isaiah 42:16?](#)

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PICTURE DESCRIPTION: A couple who left Bethel are welcomed by their new congregation.

△ **PICTURE DESCRIPTION:** A brother leaves his past behind and enjoys attending Pioneer Service School.

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